Executive Order.

WHEREAS by Executive Order No. 2868, dated May 28, 1918 I established the War Industries Board, with the functions, duties and powers outlined in my letter of March 4, 1918 to Bernard M. Baruch, its Chairman, and now, by virtue of the armistice and approaching peace, it becomes desirable to provide for the dissolution of said Board, and for the termination of its activities, in the manner hereinafter set forth.

NOW THEREFORE, I, Woodrow Wilson, President of the United States, by virtue of the authority vested in me as Chief Executive and by virtue of the powers conferred upon me by the Act of Congress entitled "An Act Authorizing the President to coordinate or consolidate executive bureaus, agencies and offices, and for other purposes, in the interest of economy and the more efficient concentration of the Government," approved May 20, 1918, as well as by virtue of any and all other Acts of Congress conferring authority upon me in the premises, do hereby order and direct:—

That the War Industries Board and all Divisions, Sections, Committees and subordinate bodies thereof, shall terminate and dissolve on January 1, 1919, save and excepting:

1. That if the Chairman finds that the proper performance of any duty duly entrusted to him or to the Board requires the continuance in office of either himself, or of any member or members of the Board or official or officials connected therewith, for a limited period after January 1, 1919, then the Board and any such official or officials thereof may, in the discretion of the Chairman, be continued for such limited period after January 1, 1919 as may be necessary for the performance of such duty, but in no event longer than the proclamation of peace. The appropriations of the War Industries Board shall be and continue available for any salaries and expenses incident to the performance of any such duty.

2. That the powers and functions of the Division of Planning and Statistics of the War Industries Board shall, on January 1, 1919, be transferred to and thereafter exercised by the War Trade Board. There shall be transferred and assigned to said War Trade Board such officials or employees of the War Industries Board, if any, as in the judgment of the Chairmen of the said two Boards may be necessary for the performance of the duties herein referred to, and also all papers, files and records appertaining thereto, and the expenses incident to said duties shall be charged against and paid from the appropriations of the War Industries Board. Upon the completion of said duties, the papers, files and records aforesaid shall be disposed of as may be hereafter directed by me, and the powers and functions hereby transferred shall thereupon cease and be at an end.

3. That the powers and functions of the Wool Division of the War Industries Board, including particularly those relating to the payment by the dealers or buyers of any sums due by them in accordance with the "Government Regulations for handling wool clip of 1918", as established by said Board on May 21, 1918, and the disposition of such payments, shall, on January 1, 1919, be transferred to and thereafter exercised by the Bureau of Markets of the Department of Agriculture, until such time as the affairs and duties of said Division, uncompleted on said date, shall have been finally completed and wound up. There shall be transferred and assigned to said Bureau of Markets such officials or employees of the War Industries Board, if any, as, in the judgment of the Chairman of the said Board and the Chief of the said Bureau, may be necessary for the performance of the duties herein referred to, and also all papers, files and records appertaining thereto, and the expenses incident to said duties shall be charged against and paid from the appropriations of the War Industries

Board. Upon the completion of said duties the papers, files and records aforesaid shall be re-transferred by the Bureau of Markets to the liquidating officer of the War Industries Board and the powers and functions hereby transferred shall thereupon cease and be at an end.

4. That the powers and functions of the Price Fixing Committee of the War Industries Board shall continue until such of the prices already fixed by said Committee, as will not expire on or before January 1, 1919, shall have expired, and the appropriations of the War Industries Board shall continue available for expenses incident to such continuance. Upon the expiration of all of such prices, the papers, files and records of said Committee shall be delivered to the liquidating officer of the War Industries Board, and the powers and functions of the Price Fixing Committee shall thereupon cease and the Committee shall be and stand dissolved.

5. That if any of the orders, directions, regulations or functions of the Board, or any of its Divisions, Committees, Sections or subordinate bodies (other than such as have heretofore been provided for in this Order) cannot, in the judgment of the Chairman, be finally abrogated, released, complied with or fulfilled with due regard to the interests involved, before January 1, 1919, then the Chairman shall designate the same to the War Trade Board, and the powers and functions now possessed by the War Industries Board with respect thereto, shall, on January 1, 1919, be transferred to and thereafter exercised by the War Trade Board, until such time as such orders, directions, regulations or functions shall have been finally abrogated, released, complied with or fulfilled. There shall be transferred and assigned to the War Trade Board such officials or employees of the War Industries Board, if any, as, in the judgment of the Chairmen of the two Boards, may be necessary for the performance of the duties herein referred to, and also all papers, files and records appertaining thereto, and the expenses incident to said duties shall be charged against and paid from the appropriations of the War Industries Board. Upon the completion of said duties, the papers, files and records aforesaid shall be re-transferred by the War Trade Board to the liquidating officer of the War Industries Board, and the powers and functions hereby transferred shall thereupon cease and be at an end.

6. That, except as hereinbefore provided, the War Industries Board shall continue after January 1, 1919 for the sole and only purpose of winding up its affairs, and of arranging, completing, indexing and inventorying its papers, files, records, accounts, property and effects, and of lawfully disposing of the same as soon as practicable and advisable: and for this purpose the Chairman may appoint a liquidating officer, who shall have such powers as may be necessary for the proper performance of said work, including the right to submit the papers, files, records and accounts of the Board to inspection by those duly authorized or entitled to inspect them, and with power also, on behalf of the Board, to continue and engage and pay such employees and to incur such expenses as may be necessary for the performance of the duties aforesaid; and also, on behalf of the Board, through such disbursing officer as he may continue or employ, to draw upon the Board's appropriations therefor, and also to draw upon such appropriations for any salaries, expenses or obligations of the Board due and unpaid on January 1, 1919, or thereafter incurred pursuant to this order.

This Order shall be effective from its date, the 31st day of December, 1918.

WOODROW WILSON

THE WHITE HOUSE,
31 December, 1918.

[No. 3019-A.]